

## AMC PATHWAY

# The Standard pathway

Last verified 2026-06-15. A guide from IMG Pathways Australia.

|                         |                                                                          |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>BEST FOR</b>         | Doctors whose qualification is not from a recognised competent authority |
| <b>LEADS TO</b>         | General registration                                                     |
| <b>WHAT IS INVOLVED</b> | AMC CAT MCQ, then the AMC clinical exam or a workplace-based assessment  |

The Standard pathway is the route for International Medical Graduates (IMGs) who aren't eligible for the competent authority or specialist pathways. You demonstrate your knowledge and clinical skills through the Australian Medical Council's (AMC) assessments, which are pitched at the level of an Australian medical graduate about to start internship. It leads to general registration with the Medical Board of Australia.

## Who the Standard pathway is for

You'll generally use the Standard pathway if your primary medical qualification isn't from a country Australia recognises as a competent authority, and you aren't applying as a specialist.

If you trained or are certified in the UK, Ireland, USA, Canada or New Zealand, check the Competent Authority pathway first, it usually skips the AMC exams. If you hold an overseas specialist qualification, see the Specialist and Expedited Specialist pathways.

## The AMC exams

The Standard pathway has two assessment stages, both run by the AMC:

1. AMC CAT MCQ examination, a computer-adaptive, multiple-choice exam testing medical knowledge.
2. AMC Clinical examination or a Workplace-Based Assessment (WBA), testing clinical skills. The WBA is an AMC-accredited alternative completed in an approved workplace under supervision.

Both are set at the standard of a newly qualified Australian medical graduate about to begin intern training. Before sitting, you create an AMC portfolio and have your qualifications verified through primary source verification.

## English language requirement

You must meet the Medical Board's English language skills registration standard. Accepted tests include IELTS Academic, OET, PTE Academic and TOEFL iBT, and results are generally valid for two years. See English requirements for the detail.

## From exams to registration

Passing the AMC assessments makes you eligible to apply to the Medical Board for registration. In practice you usually hold provisional registration while you complete a period of supervised practice (similar to an internship), then move to general registration. Registration types are explained on the registration page.

## Visas and where you can work

Most IMGs on this pathway work in employer-sponsored roles, commonly on the Skills in Demand (subclass 482) visa. As an IMG you may also be subject to the Medicare 10-year moratorium, which affects where you can bill Medicare, see [Medicare & the moratorium and where you can work](#). Migration is regulated: confirm your situation with a registered MARA agent.

## Frequently asked questions

### Do I have to sit both the MCQ and the clinical exam?

You sit the AMC CAT MCQ exam, then complete either the AMC Clinical examination or an AMC-accredited Workplace-Based Assessment, not both.

### How long does the Standard pathway take?

It varies widely depending on exam availability, when you secure a supervised post and processing times. Treat any single figure with caution and plan around your own exam dates. See [costs & timelines](#).

### Is the Standard pathway harder than the others?

It involves more assessment than the competent authority pathway because Australia hasn't pre-recognised your training system. It's not a judgement of your ability, it's about how your qualification is verified.

## Sources and last verified

1. Medical Board of Australia: Standard pathway (verified 2026-06-15)
2. Australian Medical Council: Assessment pathways to registration (verified 2026-06-15)
3. Australian Medical Council: AMC examinations and assessment (verified 2026-06-15)
4. Medical Board of Australia: English language skills registration standard (verified 2026-06-15)
5. Medical Board of Australia: Types of registration (verified 2026-06-15)
6. Department of Home Affairs: Skills in Demand visa (subclass 482) (verified 2026-06-15)
7. Medical Board of Australia: Competent Authority pathway (verified 2026-06-15)